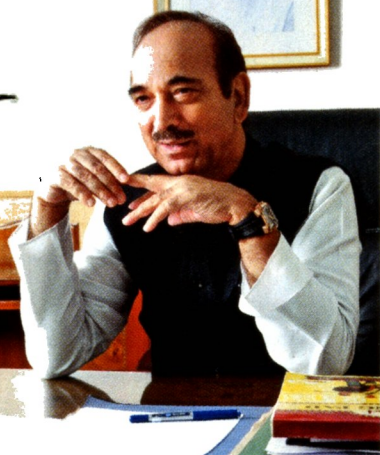


DELHI | Control Programme

The health minister has hit upon, it seems, a rather unusual method of population control—the idiot box. To his mind, it is all simple common sense. According to Ghulam Nabi Azad, if people watch more TV they will spend lesser time engaging in what he quaintly refers to as “the process of population growth”. Unabashed by the laughter that followed, Azad urged TV

AZAD



HEMANT CHAWLA

channels to provide quality coverage to serve as an adequate distraction to er... the business of making babies. The population in hospitals worries him too. “Each patient is accompanied by half-a-dozen attendants. I am proposing the construction of *sarais* (accommodation) for attendants so they can be close to the patients”. Azad is also planning to introduce an incentive scheme to speed up the construction of new hospitals and adds, “There will be penalty clauses if deadlines are not met.” **by Priya Sahgal**

BHOPAL | Justice Denied

It is a case that should re-ignite public outrage of the kind seen after the Jessica Lal murder. Three years after Professor H.S. Sabharwal was allegedly beaten to death by Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) activists, the six accused have been acquitted by a Nagpur court. Sabharwal, who taught political science at Madhav College in Ujjain, died after a row with students over the cancellation of student elections. Key witnesses, including policemen and teachers, had turned hostile. The ABVP has maintained that it was not involved in the attack. Sabharwal's wife claims that the state Government tried to weaken the case and vows to move the Supreme Court against the verdict. **by Ambresh Mishra**



SABHARWAL (LEFT)

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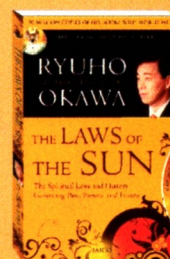
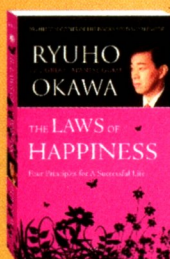
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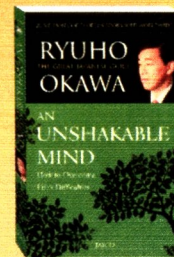
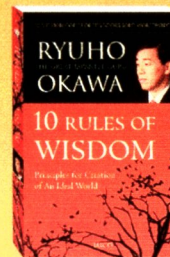
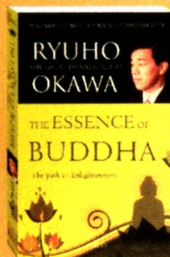
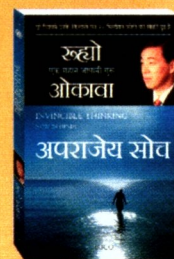
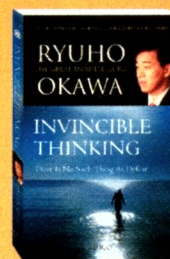
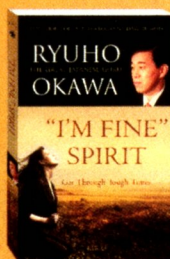
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